

SUDARSHAN REDDY RAJAPURADA

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SENIOR NETWORK ENGINEER

Senior Network Engineer with 5+ years of experience designing, implementing, and maintaining enterprise network infrastructure across on-premises data centers, private cloud, and multi-cloud environments (AWS, Azure, GCP). Deep expertise in firewall administration (Palo Alto NGFW/Panorama, Fortinet FortiGate, Cisco ASA/FirePower), enterprise routing and switching (BGP, OSPF, EIGRP, VXLAN/EVPN, Cisco ACI/Nexus 9000, Cisco SDA/DNA Center, Juniper), and F5 LTM load balancing. Proficient in cloud networking across all major platforms, network automation and Infrastructure as Code (Terraform/OpenTofu, Python, Ansible, Bash), and Zero Trust security (Zscaler ZIA/ZPA, Cisco ISE). Experienced in Syslog-NG operations, Linux system administration, VoIP (CUCM, Unity Connection, SIP Trunking), enterprise DNS (Bind, conditional forwarding, split-horizon), and network isolation/micro-segmentation (VMware NSX). Sustained 99.99% network availability, cut MTTR by ~25%, and reduced provisioning time by ~40% through automation.

AREAS OF EXPERTISE

Palo Alto NGFW & Panorama • Fortinet (FortiGate) • F5 BIG-IP LTM • Cisco ASA/FTD
Cisco ACI/Nexus 9000 • Cisco SDA/DNA Center/ISE • Juniper • Cisco Meraki
Multi-Cloud Networking (AWS, Azure, GCP) • BGP, OSPF, VXLAN/EVPN • SD-WAN
Terraform/IaC • Python/Ansible/Bash Automation • Zscaler & Zero Trust • VMware NSX
Syslog-NG & Linux Admin • VoIP (CUCM, SIP) • Enterprise DNS (Bind) • Network Isolation

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

GoHealth, USA

October 2025 – Present

Network Engineer

Optimized Palo Alto firewall and GlobalProtect VPN configurations to boost remote-access performance and improve high-availability reliability. Strengthened cloud security and identity controls to enhance user visibility and reinforce overall security posture. Leveraged enterprise network monitoring tools to proactively detect incidents and analyze performance trends. Prepared operational documentation and led cross-team coordination to improve audit readiness and accelerate issue resolution.

- Hardened the network perimeter to block advanced threats by deploying Palo Alto next-generation security features including Zone Protection Profiles, User Identification (User-ID), Anti-Spyware, and URL Filtering.
- Eliminated certificate-related outages to ensure trusted, encrypted connectivity by installing and managing SSL/TLS certificates across Palo Alto firewalls, APC PDU devices, OpenGear console servers, and VMware vCenter.
- Streamlined secure access to enable seamless single sign-on (SSO) by configuring Microsoft Entra ID enterprise applications, app registrations, and identity-based authentication across Azure.
- Strengthened cloud infrastructure operations to ensure scalable, reliable services by provisioning and managing Azure virtual machines and associated networking.
- Maintained resilient cross-cloud connectivity to ensure uninterrupted secure traffic by managing AWS site-to-site IPSec VPN tunnels and lifecycle SSL/TLS certificate management.
- Sustained virtualization platform reliability to support uninterrupted operations by managing VMware vCenter upgrades and deploying and maintaining utility servers.
- Minimized security exposure and downtime to keep infrastructure current and compliant by executing firmware upgrades across Cisco switches and Palo Alto firewalls.
- Accelerated incident resolution to reduce service disruption through structured, methodical troubleshooting across network, security, and virtualization layers.
- Turned around the branch wireless performance to sustain 99.99% network uptime by stabilizing Meraki connectivity across 10 access points.
- Prevented unnecessary hardware replacements to ensure reliable AP onboarding through deep switch-side diagnostics and power validation.
- Slashed network incident MTTR by ~25% to improve operational efficiency through proactive health monitoring.
- Maintained 99.99% firewall and VPN availability to ensure uninterrupted secure access for 300–400 remote users.
- Reduced application access failures to preserve secure connectivity by refining CDN-aware GlobalProtect policy exclusions.
- Enhanced cloud traffic visibility to accelerate security investigations through correlated Zscaler and identity log analysis.
- Ensured audit visibility to protect critical telemetry by building a resilient syslog-ng and Exabeam logging pipeline.
- Dramatically enhanced SIEM data quality to reduce operational noise by eliminating duplicate log ingestion paths.
- Laid the groundwork for operational consistency to reduce onboarding time by standardizing SOPs and runbooks.
- Modernized infrastructure visibility to lower audit and maintenance risk through comprehensive MDF/IDF documentation.
- Boosted security posture to eliminate audit risk by executing SSO- and MFA-enabled identity access for 27 NOC users.

AIG, USA (Financial Services)

January 2025 – July 2025

Network Engineer

Designed and deployed enterprise network infrastructure across data center and multi-cloud environments (AWS, Azure, GCP) within a global financial services institution. Administered firewalls, F5 load balancers, Cisco SDA/ISE, and Syslog-NG infrastructure while driving automation through Terraform, Python, and Ansible.

- Deployed Cisco SDA campus fabric (DNA Center, TrustSec, VXLAN overlay) and Cisco ACI data center fabric (Nexus 9000 series) with automated network segmentation and policy enforcement.
- Administered Cisco ISE for enterprise network access control including 802.1x authentication, device profiling, and policy-based segmentation across campus and data center environments.
- Managed Palo Alto NGFW operations including Panorama-based centralized management, GlobalProtect with certificate-based authentication, SSL decryption, content filtering, VPN failover, and high-availability configurations.
- Administered Fortinet (FortiGate) firewall policy management, VPN configuration, NAT, and high-availability support across enterprise environments.
- Configured F5 BIG-IP LTM load balancers for application delivery, traffic distribution, health monitoring, SSL offloading, and high-availability failover.
- Configured and maintained Azure networking including VNets, VNet Peering, NSGs, UDRs, Azure Firewall, Private Endpoints, Azure Private DNS, and Application Gateway.
- Architected encrypted hybrid connectivity across AWS (VPCs, Transit Gateway, Security Groups, Network ACLs, Site-to-Site IPsec VPN) and GCP (VPCs, Cloud Router, Firewall Rules).
- Engineered network isolation and segmentation across production, non-production, and recovery environments through VXLAN-based ACI and VMware NSX micro-segmentation policies.
- Built and maintained Terraform modules for multi-cloud network provisioning, configuration management, and automated deployment integrated into Git-based CI/CD pipelines.
- Automated network operations using Python, Bash, PowerShell, Ansible, and REST APIs to streamline provisioning, configuration validation, and compliance verification.
- Administered Syslog-NG infrastructure and Linux servers supporting network monitoring, SNMP-based telemetry, and log collection across the enterprise.
- Tuned large-scale BGP, OSPF, and EIGRP enterprise routing topologies to improve routing stability and designed resilient HA/DR failover architectures.
- Troubleshoot DNS resolution issues involving conditional forwarding, split-horizon DNS, and Bind across hybrid on-premises and cloud environments.
- Managed enterprise communications including VoIP, CUCM, DNS, and DHCP services to ensure 99.9% service availability.
- Supported enterprise Wi-Fi infrastructure, troubleshooting wireless connectivity, AP onboarding, and RF performance issues.
- Performed network performance monitoring, trending, and capacity planning across LAN, WAN, and cloud connectivity.
- Reduced remote-access security incidents by ~30% through zero-trust enforcement with micro-segmented access policies.
- Accelerated infrastructure scalability by ~20% to defer hardware expansion through optimized VMware ESXi engineering and capacity planning.
- Provided technical leadership, mentored junior engineers on network design and troubleshooting best practices.

Hexaware Technologies, India

June 2020 – July 2023

Network Engineer

Designed, deployed, and supported enterprise network infrastructure for globally distributed clients across on-premises data centers and multi-cloud environments (AWS, Azure, GCP). Administered Cisco, Juniper, Palo Alto, FortiGate, and F5 platforms while driving automation, mentoring junior engineers, and engaging with clients to engineer tailored solutions.

- Administered Cisco SDA campus fabric (DNA Center, TrustSec) and Cisco ACI data center fabric (Nexus 9000, VXLAN) with Juniper routing/switching across multi-vendor environments.
- Managed Cisco ISE for network access control, 802.1x enforcement, device profiling, and policy-based segmentation across enterprise campus and branch environments.
- Delivered expert-level Palo Alto NGFW operations including Panorama management, GlobalProtect with certificates, SSL decryption, content filtering, VPN failover, and HA configurations.
- Administered Fortinet (FortiGate) firewalls including policy lifecycle management, VPN, HA, firmware upgrades, and security enforcement across multi-client environments.
- Configured F5 BIG-IP LTM including virtual server configuration, pool management, health monitors, and SSL offloading for enterprise application delivery.
- Implemented multi-cloud networking across AWS (VPCs, Transit Gateway, Security Groups, IPsec VPN), Azure (VNets, NSGs, UDRs, Azure Firewall, Private Endpoints), and GCP (VPCs, Cloud Router, Cloud Interconnect).
- Developed reusable Terraform modules and automated multi-cloud network provisioning integrated into Git-based CI/CD pipelines.
- Built network automation solutions using Python, Bash, PowerShell, Ansible, and REST APIs for configuration management, compliance verification, and operational reporting.
- Implemented software-defined networking and micro-segmentation using Cisco ACI and VMware NSX, enforcing least-privilege network access and east-west traffic control.
- Administered Linux servers hosting Syslog-NG, SNMP polling, and network monitoring platforms for enterprise observability.
- Managed enterprise DNS infrastructure including Bind, conditional forwarding, split-horizon DNS, and Azure Private DNS for hybrid name resolution.
- Managed VoIP infrastructure including Cisco CUCM, UCCX, Unity Connection, and SIP Trunking for enterprise communications.
- Implemented Zscaler ZIA/ZPA and zero-trust network security principles across enterprise environments.
- Designed network architectures supporting high availability and disaster recovery with resilient BGP/OSPF routing and automated failover.
- Supported and troubleshooted enterprise Wi-Fi infrastructure across large-scale access point environments.

- Implemented network isolation strategies and secure segmented environments separating production, non-production, and management networks.
- Accelerated network deployments to cut provisioning time by ~40% through Python, Bash, PowerShell, and Ansible-driven automation.
- Reduced incident resolution time by ~30% through proactive monitoring (SolarWinds, Grafana, Splunk), structured root-cause analysis, and P1/P2 incident escalation management.
- Mentored junior team members on network design, implementation, troubleshooting, and operational best practices.
- Created and maintained comprehensive network documentation including diagrams, configurations, SOPs, and change management records.

EDUCATION

Master of Science in Cybersecurity – DePaul University (March 2025)

CERTIFICATIONS

Palo Alto Networks Certified Network Security Engineer (PCNSE) – Palo Alto Networks (July 2025)

Cisco Certified Network Associate (CCNA 200-301) – Cisco (July 2024)

Cisco Certified Specialist – Enterprise Core – Cisco (July 2025)

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Firewalls: Palo Alto NGFW (Panorama, GlobalProtect, SSL Decryption, Content Filtering, HA), Fortinet (FortiGate, FortiManager), Cisco ASA, Cisco FirePower (FTD), Zscaler (ZIA/ZPA/ZCC), Zero Trust

Cisco Platforms: Cisco ACI (Nexus 9000, VXLAN), Cisco SDA (DNA Center, TrustSec), Cisco ISE (802.1x, NAC, Profiling), Cisco Catalyst, Cisco SD-WAN, Cisco Meraki, Cisco IOS/IOS-XE

Load Balancing: F5 BIG-IP LTM (Virtual Servers, Pools, Health Monitors, SSL Offloading, HA Failover)

Juniper: Juniper Routers & Switches, Junos OS, Enterprise Routing & Switching

Routing & Switching: BGP (iBGP/eBGP), OSPF, EIGRP, MPLS, HSRP, VXLAN/EVPN, STP, VLANs, QoS, SD-WAN, VPN/IPSec, Port Channels, EtherChannel, LACP

AWS: VPCs, Transit Gateway, Security Groups, Network ACLs, PrivateLink, Site-to-Site IPsec VPN, Route Tables, EC2, Route53, ALB/NLB, EKS, GuardDuty

Azure: VNets, VNet Peering, Azure Firewall, NSGs, UDRs, Private Endpoints, Azure Private DNS, Application Gateway, API Management, Load Balancer, VPN Gateway, Entra ID

GCP: VPCs, Cloud Router, Firewall Rules, Cloud Interconnect, VPN Tunnels, Cloud DNS

Automation & IaC: Terraform (Modules, OpenTofu), Python, Bash, PowerShell, Ansible (Playbooks), REST APIs, Git/GitHub, Jenkins CI/CD, Docker, Kubernetes, Helm, Regex

Micro-Segmentation: VMware NSX, Cisco ACI, Network Isolation, Secure Enclave Design, East-West Traffic Control, Zero Trust Segmentation

Syslog & Logging: Syslog-NG (Operations, Troubleshooting, Patching, Upgrades), Exabeam SIEM, Splunk, Log Pipeline Management

Linux: Linux System Administration (RHEL, Ubuntu), Shell Access, CLI Diagnostics, Patching, Configuration Management, Capacity Planning

Monitoring: Grafana, SolarWinds, Splunk, Wireshark, tcpdump, SNMP, NetFlow, Syslog, Packet Capture, Root-Cause Analysis

DNS & Services: Bind, Conditional Forwarding, Split-Horizon DNS, Azure Private DNS, DHCP, RADIUS/AAA, TACACS+, Infoblox, NetBox (IPAM)

VoIP: Cisco CUCM, UCCX, Unity Connection, SIP Trunking, VoIP

Documentation: Network Diagrams, MDF/IDF, SOPs & Runbooks, Configuration Baselines, Change Management Records

Virtualization: VMware vCenter, VMware ESXi, VMware NSX, Hyper-V, SDN

Operating Systems: Linux/Unix (Administration & CLI), Windows Server, Cisco IOS